

1.4 SITE PREPARATION CHECKLIST

Project Name:	Site Address:
Owner-Builder:	Start Date:
Site Supervisor:	Completion Date:

INSTRUCTIONS: Complete all site preparation tasks before beginning foundation work. Proper site preparation prevents costly delays and ensures safe, efficient construction. Document completion dates and take photos of critical steps.

⚠ CRITICAL: Call 811 (or your local utility locate service) at least 2-3 business days before any digging. Hitting underground utilities can cause serious injury, death, or expensive damage. IT'S THE LAW.

PROPERTY BOUNDARY & SURVEY

☐	Task	Date Completed	Notes/Issues
☐	Obtain recent property survey (stamped by licensed surveyor)		
☐	Verify all property corners are staked/marked and visible		
☐	Identify all easements (utility, drainage, access rights-of-way)		
☐	Confirm building setback requirements from property lines		
☐	Mark setback lines with temporary stakes or flagging		
☐	Verify no encroachment on neighbors' property or easements		

UTILITY LOCATION (CALL 811)

☐	Task	Date Completed	Notes/Issues
☐			

☐	Task	Date Completed	Notes/Issues
	Call 811 for underground utility locate - MANDATORY		
☐	Ticket #: _____ Valid Until: _____		
☐	Utilities marked: ☐ Electric ☐ Gas ☐ Water ☐ Sewer ☐ Telecom ☐ Other: _____	_____	_____
☐	Take photos of all marked utility locations for records	_____	_____
☐	Hand-dig within 24" of all marked utilities (no machinery)	_____	_____
☐	Private utilities (septic, well, propane) marked by owner/contractor	_____	_____
☐	Contact utility companies if locate marks expired (renew every 30 days)	_____	_____

TREE PROTECTION & CLEARING

☐	Task	Date Completed	Notes/Issues
☐	Identify trees to be saved/protected (per plan or local ordinance)	_____	_____
☐	Install tree protection fencing at drip line (not at trunk!)	_____	_____
☐	Post "TREE PROTECTION ZONE - NO EQUIPMENT" signs	_____	_____
☐	Remove trees/vegetation in building footprint and work zones	_____	_____
☐	Grind or remove stumps in building area and driveway	_____	_____
☐	Clear brush and undergrowth from work areas	_____	_____
☐	Stockpile topsoil for later use in landscaping (if applicable)	_____	_____
☐	Dispose of debris properly (haul away, burn if permitted, chip)	_____	_____

GRADING & ACCESS

☐	Task	Date Completed	Notes/Issues
☐	Perform rough grading to establish building pad elevation	_____	_____
☐	Establish positive drainage away from building area (2% min slope)	_____	_____
☐	Create or improve access road/driveway for construction traffic	_____	_____
☐	Add gravel base to access road if needed (prevent mud/rutting)	_____	_____
☐	Ensure access road can accommodate concrete trucks, delivery trucks	_____	_____
☐	Create turnaround area for large vehicles if needed	_____	_____
☐	Level and compact area for material storage and staging	_____	_____

EROSION & SEDIMENT CONTROL

☐	Task	Date Completed	Notes/Issues
☐	Install silt fence downslope of disturbed areas	_____	_____
☐	Place erosion control matting on steep slopes (if applicable)	_____	_____
☐	Install inlet protection for storm drains	_____	_____
☐	Create temporary diversion swales if needed	_____	_____
☐	Stabilize disturbed areas not actively being worked (seed/straw)	_____	_____
☐	Inspect and maintain erosion controls weekly and after rain events	_____	_____

TEMPORARY UTILITIES & FACILITIES

☐	Task	Date Completed	Notes/Issues
TEMPORARY POWER			
☐	Contact electric utility for temporary power service	_____	_____
☐	Install temporary power pole with meter base and panel (per code)	_____	_____
☐	Inspection of temp power: ☐ Required ☐ Not Required Date: _____	_____	_____
☐	Power connected and active - Account #: _____	_____	_____
TEMPORARY WATER			
☐	Temporary water source: ☐ Municipal tap ☐ Well ☐ Water delivery	_____	_____
☐	Install temporary water line/hydrant at site	_____	_____
☐	Water available and tested - Account #: _____	_____	_____
SANITATION & WASTE			
☐	Portable toilet delivered and positioned	_____	_____
☐	Vendor: _____ Service Schedule: _____		
☐	Dumpster/waste container delivered and positioned	_____	_____
☐	Vendor: _____ Size: _____ Dump Schedule: _____		

SITE SECURITY & STORAGE

☐	Task	Date Completed	Notes/Issues
☐	Install job box or storage container for tools and materials	_____	_____
☐	Secure job box with quality locks - Lock Code/Key #: _____	_____	_____
☐	Post "NO TRESPASSING" and "HARD HAT AREA" signs	_____	_____

☐	Task	Date Completed	Notes/Issues
☐	Install temporary fencing if required by jurisdiction or for safety	_____	_____
☐	Post building permit in visible location (required by law)	_____	_____
☐	Create secure area for storing expensive materials (windows, etc.)	_____	_____
☐	Notify neighbors of construction start date and contact info	_____	_____

FINAL SITE PREPARATION CHECKS

☐	Task	Date Completed	Notes/Issues
☐	Site is level and ready for foundation layout	_____	_____
☐	Access road is passable in current weather conditions	_____	_____
☐	All required permits obtained and posted	_____	_____
☐	Utilities are located, marked, and documented with photos	_____	_____
☐	Erosion controls are in place and functional	_____	_____
☐	Temporary power and water are active and accessible	_____	_____
☐	Tool storage and sanitation facilities are in place	_____	_____
☐	Safety equipment available (first aid kit, fire extinguisher)	_____	_____
☐	Emergency contact numbers posted (911, poison control, inspector)	_____	_____
☐	Site walkthrough completed with all stakeholders	_____	_____

SITE PREPARATION SIGN-OFF

I certify that all site preparation tasks have been completed in accordance with approved plans, local codes, and safety requirements. The site is ready for foundation work to commence.

Owner-Builder Signature: _____

Date: _____

Site Supervisor (if different): _____

Date: _____

PHOTO DOCUMENTATION LOG

Take photos of site conditions before, during, and after preparation. Document utility locations, tree protection, erosion controls, and final site readiness.

Date	Photo Description	File Name/Number	Notes

NOTES & ISSUES ENCOUNTERED
